

Bernat Puertas – Curriculum Vitae

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CURRENT POSITION

PhD Candidate

Sep 2021 - present

PhD Candidate, Personal Investigador Predoctoral en Formació (PIPF)

Department of Political and Social Sciences, Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Supervisor: Dr. Abel Escribà-Folch

Thesis title: *Pathways to Personalism in Autocratic Regimes: Domestic and Foreign Factors*

EDUCATION

Master of Arts

Sep 2020 - Jun 2021

MA in Current Democracies: Nationalism, Federalism and Multiculturalism

Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Bachelor of Arts

Sep 2016 - Jun 2020

BA in Political and Administration Sciences

Universitat Pompeu Fabra

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

RA Linguatrust Project

Jan 2024 - Nov 2024

Research Assistant for the project Linguatrust (PRE150/22/000008, Institut d'Estudis de l'Autogovern, Generalitat de Catalunya)

Universitat de Barcelona, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, Universitat Oberta de Catalunya and Universitat de València

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Authoritarian Regimes, Comparative Politics, Comparative Political Economy, Authoritarian Elections, Democratization, Democratic backsliding, Research Design, Quantitative Methods.

RESEARCH STAYS

Visiting doctoral researcher

Feb 2026 - Apr 2026

Visiting doctoral researcher

GIGA German Institute of Global and Area Studies, Hamburg

Institute for Asian Studies and Research Programme 1 (Accountability and Participation).

Host: Dr. David Kuehn.

PUBLICATIONS (PEER-REVIEWED)

- Rodon, Toni, Bernat Puertas, Avel·lí Flors-Mas, Núria Franco-Guillén and Sergi Morales-Gálvez. 2026. Could you please repeat it? The effect of language, and language variety on trust in multinational settings. *Electoral Studies*, 99. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.electstud.2025.103030>
- Puertas, Bernat and Abel Escribà-Folch. 2025. Foreign aid, FDI and the personalization of power in autocracies. *Political Science Research and Methods*. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1017/psrm.2025.9>

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

- Escribà-Folch, Abel i Bernat Puertas. 2025. *El tipus de règim i el sistema internacional* (1a. ed.) [recurs d'aprenentatge textual]. Fundació Universitat Oberta de Catalunya (FUOC). PID_00305495
- Puertas, Bernat i Escribà-Folch, Abel. 2025. *Varietats d'autocràcies: actors i sistemes institucionals* (1a. ed.) [recurs d'aprenentatge textual]. Fundació Universitat Oberta de Catalunya (FUOC). PID_00305493
- Puertas, Bernat. 2024. *Disseny de la Investigació: Els Enfocaments de Recerca*. (1a ed.) [recurs d'aprenentatge textual]. Fundació Universitat Oberta de Catalunya (FUOC). PID_00302955
- Puertas, Bernat. 2024. *Disseny de la Investigació: Mètodes i Tècniques*. (1a ed.) [recurs d'aprenentatge textual]. Fundació Universitat Oberta de Catalunya (FUOC). PID_00302954.
- Puertas, Bernat and Toni Rodon. 2024. Does Language Affect Political Trust? An Exploration of Language Attitudes in the Political Field in Multilingual Catalonia. Pre-Analysis Plan. *OSF*. Available at: https://osf.io/zk3e4/overview?view_only=3fbb14597c734896a2d53b5142a589a2

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

- “The onset of civil armed conflicts and personalization of power in dictatorships” (under review).
- “Personalism and International Conflict: How Dictators Fight to Concentrate Power” (under review).
- “Ballots for the Boss: Multiparty Elections and Personalization of Power in Autocratic Regimes”

TEACHING

TA Comparative Politics and Democratization Sep 2022 - present
Teaching assistant responsible for the seminars of the course “Comparative Politics and Democratization”
MA in International Relations
Institut Barcelona d'Estudis Internacionals (IBEI)

TA Public Policy I Apr 2025 - Jun 2025
Teaching assistant responsible for the seminars of the course “Polítiques Públiques I” (Public Policy I)
BA in Political and Administrative Sciences
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

TA Introduction to Political Science Sep 2025 - present
Teaching assistant responsible for the seminars of the course “Introducció a la Ciència Política” (Introduction to Political Science)
BA in Political and Administrative Sciences
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

TA Qualitative Methodology II Sep 2025 - present
Teaching assistant responsible for the seminars of the course “Metodologia Qualitativa II” (Qualitative Methodology II)
BA in Political and Administrative Sciences
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Instructor of Introduction to Quantitative Methodology Nov 2025
Instructor of the course “Introducción a la Metodología Cuantitativa” (Introduction to Quantitative Methodology)
Master in Political and Institutional Communication

Affiliated Teaching Staff Research Design in IR

Nov 2025

Affiliated teaching staff for the course “Diseño de investigación en estudios internacionales” (Research Design in International Studies)

BA in International Studies

Universitat Oberta de Catalunya

Creator and instructor of summer course

Jun 2022 - present

Creator and instructor of the course “Com governar en el segle XXI: Estats, Conflicte i Poder” (How to govern in the 21st Century? States, Conflict, and Power)

Campus Junior

Universitat Pompeu Fabra

PARTICIPATION IN PROJECTS

Project Linguatrust

Jan 2024 - Nov 2024

Research Assistant for the project Linguatrust (PRE150/22/000008, Institut d’Estudis de l’Autogovern, Generalitat de Catalunya)

Universitat de Barcelona, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, Universitat Oberta de Catalunya and Universitat de València

Membership in IPA Research Group

Sep 2021 - present

Institutions and Political Actors Research Group

Department of Political and Social Sciences

Universitat Pompeu Fabra

ADMINISTRATIVE APPOINTMENTS

Elected post-graduate representative

Feb 2022 - Jan 2023

Department Board of the Department of Political and Social Sciences

Universitat Pompeu Fabra

GRANTS, SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

Pre-doctoral grant

Apr 2025 - present

Pre-doctoral grant. Personal Investigador Predoctoral en Formació (PIPF)

Department of Political and Social Sciences

Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Beca Santander Idiomas

2021

Beca Santander Idiomas, English Up

British Council

Banco Santander

High school award

2016

Award of high school’s honors graduate

City council of Terrassa

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

Populismo, erosión democrática y autocracias

Feb 2025

“Populismo, erosión democrática y autocracias.” (Populism, democratic backsliding and autocracies) in

“Seminario Política Comparada, Populismo y Democracia”, Institut Barcelona d’Estudis Internacionals and Pontificia Universidad Católica de Perú, Academic coordinator: Prof. Ana Sofía Cardenal.

CONFERENCES AND EVENTS PRESENTATIONS (P) & DISCUSSION (D)

- EPSA 2023 (P, P), 2024 (P)
- IPA Research Group Seminars (UPF) 2022 (P), 2023 (P), 2024 (P)
- Barcelona PhD Workshop on Empirical Political Science 2022 (D), 2023 (P)
- SISP General Conference 2022 (P)
- ECPR Summer School SGIR 2022 (P)

PARTICIPATION IN WORKSHOPS, SUMMER AND WINTER SCHOOLS

ECPR Summer School SGIR 2022

European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR) Summer School of the Standing Group on International Relations

Universitat Ramon Llull

RECSM Summer Methods School 2022

9th Edition of the Research and Expertise Centre for Survey Methodology (RECSM) Summer Methods School

Universitat Pompeu Fabra

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Causal Inference 2022

9th Edition of the Research and Expertise Centre for Survey Methodology (RECSM) Summer Methods School, Instructor: Prof. Bruno Arpino

Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Working with Concepts in the Social Sciences 2022

Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Instructor: Frederic Schaffer (University of Massachusetts).

ACADEMIC PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- Reviewer at: *Conflict Management and Peace Science Journal*; *Democratization*.
- Co-organizer of the Linguatrust workshop “Language, democracy and political trust: An interdisciplinary perspective from political theory, political science and sociolinguistics” (18 November, 2024)
- Advisor at Universitat Oberta de Catalunya to create the modules of the courses on Research Design; Autocratic Regimes (with Abel Escribà-Folch) of the MA in Political Analysis.

MERITS AND SKILLS

Languages

- Catalan: Mother tongue
- Spanish: Native level

- English: Advanced level

Skills

- R and RStudio
- STATA
- L^AT_EX
- Qualtrics